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Allocation Package Narrative Explanation

A. Funding and service actions a being taken within the region that utilize resources other than SB125 funding

On an annual basis, MST actively applies for and receives a variety of local, state, and federal formula and competitive grants to support operating and capital projects. Some of these grant programs include AB 2766, Measure X, Local Transportation Fund, State Transit Assistance, California Climate Investments, FTA 5307, 5310, 5311, 5311(f), 5339, and others. These grant funding sources account for 87% of MST's operating budget. MST has a long history of developing and maintaining private and public partnerships which provide additional funding to support operating costs. An innovative partnership was formed with the military, and substantial revenue was generated before the pandemic. At one point, passenger fares accounted for as much as 23% of the agency's revenue (2017), but with the drop in ridership and loss of the military partnership, farebox recovery has fallen dramatically.

Addressing MST's operational deficit, using all available funds, through 2025-26 and beyond, MST has taken a pro-active approach to re-imagine its entire bus service network, known as the Better Bus Network. The Better Bus Network was designed to increase efficiency and provide more useful services where they are needed the most and where ridership increases are expected. MST completed the systemwide redesign in 2021 and implemented it in December of 2022. The Better Bus Network involved a two-year planning process that heavily relied on public involvement to shape the service plan. Since implementing the Better Bus Network, MST has seen a 25% increase in ridership compared to last year. As part of the network redesign, and to increase ridership, MST updated its complicated three tier fare structure by decreasing bus fares and making it less complicated. The change in fare policy was designed to increase ridership and build a long-term rider base. The new transit network focuses on high frequency service in low-income and minority communities, parts of MST's service area with the greatest amount of zero car households and transit-dependent individuals. Targeting these areas was

the first strategy to increase ridership. The second strategy was to lower fares to make them more affordable for low-income, transit dependent users.

The Better Bus Network analyzed three service plans: Low, Medium, and High. The Low scenario is a contingency plan for reduced service should local, state, and federal funding decline significantly. The Medium scenario is a status-quo plan in terms of total service hours but reallocates service distribution and span of hours. The High scenario is a “best-case-scenario” plan should additional funding become available and is designed to significantly grow ridership by providing increased service systemwide. MST implemented most of the Medium scenario. There are some parts of the Medium scenario that have not been fully implemented due to bus driver shortage. Overtime pay is being incurred to implement other parts of the medium service plan.

A third strategy to increase transit ridership is MST’s adoption of the California Integrated Travel Project (CalITP). MST integrated an open-loop payment system for passengers to conveniently pay their bus fare with any contactless enabled credit/debit card or e-wallet. About 8% of transactions are now through the contactless fare payment system.

In 2022, MST worked with the two local community colleges and California State University Monterey Bay to establish the College EcoSmart Pass Program. The program allows any college student to board MST for free using a valid student identification card. The college or university is then billed the cost of actual student ridership. MST will continue seeking these types of innovative community partnerships to generate revenue and grow ridership.

B. Strategies involving the use of non-SB 125 funds to increase transit operator funding, allowing SB 125 to target capital needs

This funding is necessary to protect transit service over the next several years, as California’s transit agencies, including MST, collectively face a multibillion-dollar funding operating shortfall, while also maintaining capacity to build transformative capital projects needed to meet our state’s future mobility needs.

Before March 2020, transit ridership was declining throughout the country due to a combination of the record-low fuel prices, low cost of car ownership, increased availability of driver's licenses to undocumented individuals, and loss of affordable housing among those who traditionally depend on public transportation. Monterey County was not immune to these issues. However, MST was driving overall ridership with programs that make transit look free to passengers on certain lines. MST established its first free transit service 25 years ago, partnering with the city of Monterey and the Monterey Bay Aquarium on the Waterfront Area Visitor Express (WAVE). Now operating as the Monterey Trolley, the seasonal service transports visitors and residents between downtown Monterey, the Aquarium and Cannery Row. Since then, MST has expanded its free fare offerings by tapping into California Climate Investment Grant (formerly cap-and-trade) funds and teaming up with public and nonprofit partners. The key to these partnerships was demonstrating that MST is responsible and responsive to the needs of the community, while helping third parties recognize that public transit investments reduce traffic congestion, cut greenhouse gas emissions, and improve overall quality of life.

In 2009, the Presidio of Monterey (POM) partnered with MST to implement commuter services from remote military housing locations directly to each military base. This program was 100% funded under the military federal transit benefit. Over the years, ridership grew from zero to over 900,000 passenger boardings comprising one-fifth of all MST passenger trips. By leveraging federal transit benefits and creating routes that serve the Defense Language Institute, Naval Postgraduate School, Fort Hunter Liggett, and Camp Roberts MST provided a convenient, affordable, and environmentally friendly transportation option for both enlisted individuals and civilian staffers. However, in fall 2019 the Presidio of Monterey began implementing program changes which resulted in fewer military members enrolling in the Mass Transit Benefit Program which funded the special transit service to the POM. As a result, MST cut back service to the base in February 2020 to reduce costs associated with operating several POM transit lines. Further, in March 2020, MST suspended all lines serving the military bases while the Shelter-In-Place order was in effect. One line was restored for a short period before permanently being discontinued in 2022.

After four previously failed attempts at raising local sales taxes in Monterey County, MST proposed its own in 2014 to fund essential transit services for seniors, veterans, and people with disabilities. Local voters overwhelmingly approved Measure Q in November 2014, supporting a 15-year, 1/8-cent local sales tax. MST has, and continues to, invest these local funds in everything from 50-percent fare reductions for the MST RIDES ADA paratransit program, to new routes serving seniors and veterans, to expanded taxi voucher programs and mobility services.

MST's groundbreaking "Ride the 40s on Us" campaign offered free weekend and holiday fares on 40s routes in the city of Salinas, funded through the Low Carbon Transit Operations Program (LCTOP). Established as a pilot program in 2017, the Ride the 40s initiative was so well received that MST's Board of Directors extended funding into 2020. MST was able to sustain an 80% increase in weekend passenger boardings translating into over 100,000 additional passengers traveling to shopping centers, medical appointments, family functions, and religious events at no cost during the first year of the free fare program. With the state's Innovative Clean Transit Regulation, MST now must use its annual LCTOP funds to invest in vehicle replacements and can no longer provide free fares in Salinas.

Operating revenues from passenger fares and partnerships in FY 2019-2020 compared to FY 2018-19 decreased by \$3.4 Million from \$8.7 Million to \$5.3 Million primarily because of continued decreasing levels of military and civilian participation in the Mass Transportation Benefit Program as well as the effects of the COVID-19 pandemic including lower partnership revenues, farebox revenue losses, and lower retail sales taxes. In late March 2020, Congress passed, and the President signed the Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security (CARES) Act which identified \$25 Billion for public transportation operators throughout the Nation. MST was allocated \$25 Million to help pay for the increased costs associated with responding to the pandemic, loss of farebox revenue and ongoing operating expenses which included increased personal protective equipment (PPE), cleaning supplies, and eligible capital expenses.

FY 2021 began with the continuation of the COVID-19 pandemic. A significant reduction in ridership had already begun in early 2020 due to changes implemented by MST's long-standing Presidio of Monterey (POM) military partner and the onset of stay-at-home orders in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. On December 27, 2020, the Coronavirus Response and Relief Supplemental Appropriations Act of 2021 (CRRSAA) was signed into law, which included \$900 Billion in supplemental appropriations for COVID-19

relief, \$14 Billion of which was allocated to support the transit industry during the COVID-19 public health emergency. Of that amount, MST was allocated \$6.08 Million to help pay for the increased costs associated with responding to the pandemic, loss of farebox revenue and ongoing operating expenses including PPE, cleaning supplies, and eligible capital expenses. Despite the additional federal aid, ridership remained low. At the end of fiscal year 2021, the MST fixed-route bus system consisted of thirty fixed-routes, down from sixty-one prior to the pandemic and military service reductions.

Operating revenues from passenger fares and partnerships in FY 2020-21, when compared to FY 2019-20, decreased by \$3.4 Million from \$5.3 Million to \$1.9 Million primarily because of the continued effects of the COVID-19 pandemic including farebox revenue losses, lower partnership revenues, and continued decreasing levels of military and civilian participation in the Mass Transportation Benefit Program. Over \$8 Million in capital contributions were needed to offset the agency's operating expenses in FY 2020-21.

In FY 2021-22, innovative partnerships with the local colleges, City of Monterey, and Monterey Bay Aquarium were reinstated as the community transitioned into the recovery phase of the pandemic. The College EcoSmart Pass Program for students and faculty/staff at Cal State Monterey Bay, and students at Monterey Peninsula College and Hartnell College returned. These contracts span several years and give MST some certainty as to revenue estimates in the operational years. MST and Commute with Enterprise began a partnership in Fall 2022 to provide a subsidized vanpool program. It's a flexible alternative to regularly scheduled public transit routes. The program also makes commuting more environmentally sustainable and affordable than driving alone, especially when gas prices are high. This program fills a gap in providing transit service to parts of Monterey County that are no longer served by fixed routes after the MST Better Bus Network took effect in December 2022.

The American Rescue Plan Act of 2021 (ARPA), which President Biden signed on March 11, 2021, includes \$30.5 Billion in federal funding to support the nation's public transportation systems as they continued to respond to the COVID-19 pandemic and support the President's call to vaccinate the U.S. population. Of that amount, MST was allocated \$14.8 Million to help continue paying for the increased costs associated with responding to the pandemic, loss of farebox revenue and ongoing operating expenses.

Through these federal relief programs, MST was able to fund a comprehensive operational analysis of its system, which led to a redesigned transit network which was implemented in December 2022. The new system prioritizes riders who are transit dependent and aims to increase long-term ridership.

As noted in the SB 125 guidelines, preventing service reductions and elimination includes the broad variety of expenses required to provide those services, including those related to ensuring safety and state of good repair of the vehicles and infrastructure. MST's Zero-Emissions Bus (ZEB) Rollout Plan was approved by the California Air Resources Board (CARB) in compliance with the Innovative Clean Transit (ICT) regulation. This requires MST to upgrade its fleet to ZEBs as the older diesel buses meet their FTA defined useful life benchmark and get replaced. MST will continue to seek federal, state, regional and local funds to fill a \$100 Million unfunded mandate to transition to a zero emissions fleet over 18 years. All replacement vehicles in MST's large bus fleet are now 36% more expensive than their biofuel/diesel counterparts, and with the ICT mandate, MST can only purchase zero-emissions vehicles going forward.

On December 6, 2023, the TAMC board approved use of Monterey County Measure X funds to cover a \$9,234,350 construction cost need for the MST SURF! Busway and Bus Rapid Transit Project. Now at 95% design, the total project budget has exceeded prior estimates, and there is a funding gap. The innovative use of Measure X funding will cover this gap.

C. Description and justification of the RTPA strategy to use SB 125 funding to construct capital projects and fund operating expenses that lead to improved outcomes in its jurisdiction.

TAMC will use 50% of the SB 125 funds for rail projects: the Rail Extension to Monterey County project construction, Coast Rail Positive Train Control construction, the Pajaro/Watsonville Multimodal Station design phase, and the King City Multimodal Station construction. SB 125 funding will be used for project phases not eligible or typically not competitive for grants to better position the rail projects where they are competitive. New rail service in Monterey County will help residents get to jobs, health care, shopping, and other travel opportunities conveniently, safely, and cheaply, while avoiding traffic jams. Rail projects are an important component of the regional integrated transportation network that will enhance mobility opportunities for our diverse population and be transformative for the region.

In 2021, TAMC adopted a **Monterey Bay Area Rail Network Integration Study**¹. This work was funded by a Transit and Intercity Rail Capital Program (TIRCP) grant. The purpose of this study was to lay the groundwork for implementing the 2018 California State Rail Plan in the Monterey Bay Area by determining the optimal options for: rail connectivity and operations, equipment needs, governance, and community benefits for service between Monterey County and Santa Clara County, Monterey and Santa Cruz, and the Coast Rail Corridor. This study provided the data needed to prepare grant applications for funding new stations at Pajaro/Watsonville, Castroville, Soledad, and King City.

The **Rail Extension to Monterey County** project will extend passenger rail service from Santa Clara County south to Salinas. This is a transformative project that will revitalize the downtown Salinas train station and create new multimodal transportation hubs for the disadvantaged communities of Pajaro and Castroville. TAMC is pursuing a phased implementation of the Project. Phase 1, known as the Kick Start Project², includes Salinas train station circulation improvements, a train layover facility in Salinas, and track improvements at the Gilroy station and between Salinas and Gilroy. The Initial Service (first of three phases) of the Rail Extension to Monterey County will attract 188,800 annual rail trips and 4,700 annual bus trips in the corridor between San Francisco and San Luis Obispo. The Kick Start Project has wrapped up construction of Package 1, improvements at the Salinas train station. The layover facility (Package 2) and Gilroy track improvements (Package 3) are now in final design. TAMC has acquired most of the property needed for the layover facility, pending negotiations with Union Pacific Railroad (UPRR) for acquisition or encroachment agreements for five UPRR-owned parcels. Construction of the Salinas layover facility is funded via a TIRCP grant in 2018 and State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP) funding. Construction of the Gilroy track connections is funded via Traffic Congestion Relief Program (TCRP) funding. The \$5 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding will construct improvements to the

¹ Monterey Bay Area Rail Network Integration Study, TAMC, 2021:

https://www.tamcmonterey.org/files/259cbdfbd/Final_Network_Integration_Study_210729.pdf

² Kick Start Project: <https://tamcmonterey.specialdistrict.org/monterey-county-rail-extension-phase-1-kick-start-project>

tracks between Salinas and Gilroy, pending a capacity study and negotiations with Union Pacific, underway now.

The Caltrans/UPRR **Coast Rail Positive Train Control** (PTC) project would install PTC technology along three segments of UPRR's Coast Subdivision from Gilroy to San Luis Obispo. PTC systems use communication-based and processor-based train control technology to reliably and functionally prevent train-to-train collisions, overspeed derailments, incursions into established work zone limits, and movements of trains through switches in the wrong position. There is a federal mandate for PTC to be implemented on any corridor that carries freight and more than two round trips of passenger rail service. Currently, the corridor carries only one passenger round trip, the Amtrak Coast Starlight. The federal PTC requirement would be triggered by the Rail Extension to Monterey County's proposed two passenger round trips from Gilroy to Salinas. TAMC has already contributed \$1,615,000 of its TIRCP cycle 3 allocation for the Rail Extension to Monterey County toward the PTC project via a Funds Transfer Agreement with Caltrans. Caltrans has secured state and federal funding for this project, but cost escalation has led to a funding gap for construction. TAMC's proposed contribution of \$4,694,523 in SB 125 TIRCP funding will show strong local support for closing this last gap on the California rail network, the rest of which already has PTC installed.

The **Pajaro/Watsonville Multimodal Station** project³, Phase 2 of the Rail Extension to Monterey County project, is in the development phase and has been difficult to fund. The proposed Pajaro/Watsonville station is in the Monterey County unincorporated community of Pajaro. The station site is approximately 1.5 miles from downtown Watsonville in the County of Santa Cruz. This station will be the connection point for Santa Cruz County to new passenger rail service on the Coast mainline tracks between Salinas and the San Francisco Bay Area. The station will transform a currently blighted area by providing a new community transportation hub that will entice transit-oriented housing and community services to the surrounding area. The Initial Service additional ridership for the Pajaro/Watsonville Multimodal Station is 60,200 riders annually. The \$8.27 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding will go toward the design phase of the project, the next step after the TIRCP cycle 6-funded environmental review phase is completed.

King City's Accelerated Access Rail Platform and Multi-Modal Transit Center (MMTC) will bring new mobility opportunities to an underserved rural community, increase connectivity, provide access to jobs and services benefiting low-income and underserved minority communities, provide new housing opportunities, and promote economic development. The King City station will support Fort Hunter Liggett's resiliency goals and the U.S. Army's Energy and Environmental Sustainability efforts to reduce emissions and its carbon footprint. The project consists of the construction of the accelerated rail platform, rail realignment, parking lot, and staging area for Fort Hunter Liggett, which serves as a training facility for all U.S. military service branches and hosts approximately 50,000 visitors and soldiers annually. The King City station is not a current TIRCP recipient, but has previous TIRCP applications and the project will be included in the Coast Rail Coordinating Council TIRCP cycle 7 application. The \$7.5 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding would help close the gap in construction costs for the King City station, matching the following funding already secured as well as the prospective TIRCP cycle 7 grant: \$7.5 million Interregional Transportation Improvement Program (ITIP), \$5 million Amtrak contribution,

³ Pajaro/Watsonville: <https://tamcmonterey.specialdistrict.org/monterey-county-rail-extension-phase-2-pajaro-watsonville>

and \$6.375 million in State Rail Assistance (SRA). Should the project not succeed in TIRCP cycle 7, the City would seek federal funding via the Department of Defense (DOD) Defense Community Infrastructure Program and/or the Rebuilding American Infrastructure with Sustainability and Equity (RAISE) programs to fully fund construction.

The remaining 50% of funding will go towards MST's transit operations. The operating funding provided through SB 125 will ensure MST is able to maintain service levels, mitigate fare increases, increase ridership and prevent staff layoffs. These critical funds are a bridge for MST to continue to maintain existing service levels established in the Better Bus Network. Between January and August of 2023, MST has seen an average monthly ridership increase of 25% when compared to the same period in 2022. These bridge operating funds will ensure MST is able to maintain service levels and continue this ridership growth. MST recently opened Line 59, which is partially funded through FTA's 5311(f) Rural and Intercity Bus Program. This new service connects Salinas to Gilroy and was developed and funded in partnership with Santa Clara Valley Transportation Authority (VTA).

D. A detailed breakdown and justification for how the funding is proposed to be distributed between transit operators and among projects, consistent with the legislative intent described in SB 125.

TAMC board voted to take the \$524,758 in administrative funding off the top and split the remaining funding allocation equally between MST and TAMC. MST will be using all of its allocated funding for transit operations. TAMC will distribute the funding to high priority capital projects with existing funding from TIRCP as well as high priority regional projects that are TIRCP eligible and in need of additional resources for completion. Data tables with background on transit operator data and capital projects are attached.

The **MST Operating Funding** provided through SB 125 will ensure MST is able to maintain service levels, mitigate fare increases, increase ridership, and prevent staff layoffs. The remaining \$7,458,807 of ZETCP funding to be awarded to TAMC will be allocated to MST, and \$18,516,716 of the TIRCP funds will go towards the MST operations funding, reaching a total of \$25,975,523. As detailed in the Transit Operator Worksheet, MST will use the allocated total of \$25,975,523 to prevent service reduction and increase ridership over the next four years through FY 26-27.

The **Rail Extension to Monterey County** project will extend passenger rail service from Santa Clara County south to Salinas. This is a transformative project that will revitalize the downtown Salinas train station and create new multimodal transportation hubs for the disadvantaged communities of Pajaro and Castroville. TAMC has acquired most of the property needed for the layover facility, pending negotiations with Union Pacific Railroad (UPRR) for acquisition or encroachment agreements for five UPRR-owned parcels. Construction of the Salinas layover facility is funded via a TIRCP grant in 2018 and State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP) funding. Construction of the Gilroy track connections is funded via Traffic Congestion Relief Program (TCRP) funding now. The \$5 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding will construct improvements to the tracks between Salinas and Gilroy, pending a capacity study and negotiations with Union Pacific, underway now.

The Caltrans/UPRR **Coast Rail Positive Train Control (PTC)** project would install PTC technology along three segments of UPRR's Coast Subdivision from Gilroy to San Luis Obispo. Caltrans has secured state

and federal funding for this project, but cost escalation has led to a funding gap for construction. TAMC's contribution of \$4,694,523 in SB 125 TIRCP funding will show strong local support for closing this last gap on the California rail network, the rest of which already has PTC installed.

The **Pajaro/Watsonville Multimodal Station** project⁴, Phase 2 of the Rail Extension to Monterey County project, is in the development phase and has been difficult to fund. This project is a priority in the 2023 draft California Rail Plan for near term development. The \$8.781 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding will go toward the design phase of the project, the next step after the TIRCP cycle 6-funded environmental review phase is completed. Three previous TIRCP applications for this project failed because the project was in the project development phase. The SB 125 funding will provide much needed additional pre-construction funding that is difficult to receive from competitive state and federal grant programs. This is a high priority station in an underserved community.

King City's Accelerated Access Rail Platform and Multi-Modal Transit Center (MMTC) will bring new mobility opportunities to an underserved rural community, increase connectivity, provide access to jobs and services benefiting low-income and underserved minority communities, provide new housing opportunities, and promote economic development. The King City station is not a current TIRCP recipient but has previous TIRCP applications and the project will be included in the Coast Rail Coordinating Council TIRCP cycle 7 application. The \$7.5 million in SB 125 TIRCP funding would help close the gap in construction costs for the King City station, matching the following funding already secured as well as the prospective TIRCP cycle 7 grant: \$7.5 million Interregional Transportation Improvement Program (ITIP), \$5 million Amtrak contribution, and \$6.375 million in State Rail Assistance (SRA). More details about the project can be found in the King City TIRCP fact sheet.

Allocation Package Detailed Project Description

i. TIRCP Capital

1. Existing TIRCP Project: Identify the title of the project and the TIRCP cycle of award (cycles 1-6). Identify whether the funds will be used for the full project or for a subcomponent. Each project receiving additional funding shall identify the reason for additional funds being needed, including cost escalation, additional scope requirements or maintaining federal funding commitments. No additional GHG reduction or increased ridership benefits are required to request funds for an existing TIRCP project

Rail Extension to Monterey County project, TIRCP Cycle 3. Funds will be used to construct improvements to the tracks between Salinas and Gilroy, pending a capacity study and negotiations with Union Pacific, underway now.

Pajaro/Watsonville Multimodal Station, TIRCP Cycle 6. Funds will be used for design of the station project.

⁴ Pajaro/Watsonville: <https://tamcmonterey.specialdistrict.org/monterey-county-rail-extension-phase-2-pajaro-watsonville>

Central Coast Positive Train Control, TIRCP Cycle 3. Funds will be used as a subcomponent to cover cost escalation.

2. New TIRCP-eligible Projects:

King City Multi-Modal Transit Center -Attachment A

ii. ZETCP- No ZETCP Capital projects are requested.

iii. Transit Operations

1. Name of Transit Operator – Monterey-Salinas Transit District
2. 2022-23 Ridership for the Operator and Operator's Percent of Region's Total Ridership

MST carried 2.2 million passengers in 2022 and provided 100% of the public transit service in Monterey County.

3. Amount of Funding Requested, by source (TIRCP or ZETCP) and Budget Year

- a. TIRCP Year 1: \$4,499,168
- b. TIRCP Year 2: \$14,017,548
- c. ZETCP Year 1: \$2,450,934
- d. ZETCP Year 2-4: \$1,669,291

4. List of Specific Activities Funded by the Request, quantified where possible:

- a. Amount of service being paid for by the additional funding, costs involved in maintaining current operations.

MST is the only STA-eligible transit operator in Monterey County. Under the Comprehensive Operational Analysis, MST identified three general-funded (not partner sponsored) levels of service based on funding availability: Low, Medium, and High. The estimated annual service hours for each of the service levels are as follows: Low – 163,000, Medium – 176,000, and High – 228,000. MST is currently operating just short of the Medium service level. Without these funds MST would be forced to operate at the Low service level, which is a 13,000-hour reduction in vehicle revenue hours. The requested funds support 8% of MST's operating budget. Without these funds, MST could be forced to reduce service to the Low service level or below. This reduction in service would represent at least a 10% reduction in overall service levels compared to pre-Covid 19 pandemic levels of service. MST budgets roughly \$444,000 per month dedicated to operating and maintaining vehicles in a state of good repair. These funds are critical operating expenses for the safe operation of MST service. Reducing service levels results in lowering ridership levels and impacts the most vulnerable in our communities who rely on transit to get to jobs, healthcare, shopping, and other services.

- b. Identification of operating expenses invested in increased safety and security measures –

On an annual basis, MST invests at least 1% of its FTA 5307 Urbanized Area Formula funding into increased safety and security measures. For FY 23-24, MST budgeted \$3,189,350 for security and cybersecurity expenses. Foot patrol security guards are present at the Salinas Transit Center and Marina Transit Exchange. MST has begun installing Q-Straint technology for ADA riders which cuts down on coach operator injuries and subsequent workers compensation claims while also improving rider safety. This will reduce future MST liability claims. MST anticipates increasing its cyber security measures systemwide by 3.75% over the coming fiscal year.

- c. Identification of operating expenses that are intended to increase ridership, including those that fund actions to improve coordination of routes and schedules –

Since implementing the Better Bus Network, MST has seen a 25% increase in ridership compared to last year. As part of the network redesign, and to increase ridership, MST updated its fare structure. Lowering bus fares was a strategy to increase ridership. The new transit network focuses on high frequency service in low-income and minority communities, parts of MST's service area with the greatest amount of zero car households and transit-dependent individuals. Compared to 2019, MST has increased coach operator's salaries and hiring bonuses that MST offers by 39.6%. This strategy was intended to recruit more coach operators so MST can deliver increased service which results in ridership increases. Additionally, MST is committed to making riding transit easier and more efficient by removing barriers to riding transit through rolling out a contactless fare payment system for its fixed route buses. This system is in alignment with the California Integrated Travel Project (Cal-ITP). Coordination of routes and schedules is important for riders connecting to other transit systems. MST provides General Transit Feed Specification (GTFS) with real-time information and promotes use of Transit app for its riders to make timely and seamless connections with neighboring transit operators. The GTFS is incorporated into every MST service change process as part of general operating procedures, so information is always updated.

5. Identification of benefits to transit dependent riders of activities funded by the request

These critical bridge funds will ensure MST can continue to provide transit services for transit dependent riders countywide. MST recently lowered bus fares

as a strategy to increase ridership and support transit dependent riders, many of whom live or work in low-income, disadvantaged, or historically underserved communities. MST's current transit network, also known as the Better Bus Network, focuses on high frequency service in low-income, disadvantaged, and minority communities, parts of MST's service area with the greatest amount of zero car households and transit-dependent individuals. The Better Bus Network analyzed three service plans: Low, Medium, and High. The Low scenario is a contingency plan for reduced service should local, state, and federal funding decline. The Medium scenario is a status-quo plan in terms of total service hours but reallocates service distribution and span of hours. The High scenario is a "best-case-scenario" plan should additional funding become available through a local sales tax measure or similar funding source. MST implemented most of the Medium scenario. There are some parts of the Medium scenario that have not been fully implemented due to bus driver shortage, and overtime pay is being incurred to implement other parts of the Medium service plan. Roughly 6.3% of Monterey County's populace live in a severely disadvantaged community. A severely disadvantaged community is defined here as a community that falls between the 71st and 100th percentile as defined by CalEnviroScreen 4.0. Since the implementation of the Better Bus Network in December of 2022, MST has averaged 23.6% of its trips departing from severely disadvantaged communities. Without this bridge funding, MST may have to cut service to the Low scenario, which would significantly reduce access to essential services for transit dependent riders countywide.

Regionally representative transit operator data

- iv. Existing fleet and asset management plans by transit operators
 1. Innovative Clean Transit Plan developed for CARB considered an already responsive component of this requirement – Attachment B
 2. IF submitted Asset Information Module data to the FTA's National Transit Database, confirm last time period for which data was submitted, whether they submitted their data as part of a group plan

This was last submitted as an individual plan on 10/26/23 for the period of 7/1/22 through 6/30/23.
 3. Any operator specific fleet and/or asset management plans for own management purposes or for FTA Capital Investment Program requirements – Attachment C
- v. Revenue collection methods and annual costs involved in collecting revenue for each transit operator and regional transportation planning agency involved, by payment instrument.
 1. Methods of revenue collection noted and described, including cash fareboxes, transit passes, smart cards, mobile ticketing, tickets for sale at different locations and in different media

MST recently installed open-loop contactless fare payment validators on its buses that allow riders to use their Visa and Mastercard contactless-enabled bank credit/debit cards and mobile wallets such as Apple Pay, Google Pay, Samsung Pay, and FitBit Pay. MST also has fareboxes that accept traditional fare media including cash, MST GoPasses, and MST GoCards.
 2. Revenue collection cost information when able to identify specific costs in their operating or capital budgets associated with such revenue collection costs. Annual cost should be related to annual revenue for each operator that has relevant data to report.
 - a. The dataset shall include, for each transit operator or regional transportation planning agency involved in revenue collection (as applicable):
 - a. Total cost of revenue collection and total revenue collected for the most recent fiscal year

Total cost of revenue collection for FY 22/23 was \$728,682. Expenses associated with revenue collection include bank fees, armored car services, farebox collection, open-loop contactless fare payment system, and the Square retail system at customer service locations for bus pass sales. Total fare revenue collected for FY 22/23 was \$2,393,852, this excludes special transit.
 - b. Cost of revenue collection by payment instrument (where available, even if only for certain instruments and not all) and total revenue collected by those same payment instruments, for the most recent fiscal year. – MST utilizes several payment systems for revenue

collection. A breakdown of the total revenue received for each of these systems in FY 22/23 is included below:

- i. Open-loop Contactless Fare Payment System - \$141,342.15
 - ii. Square Payment System - \$482,603.60
 - iii. MV Transportation - \$71,591.48
 - iv. Farebox - \$1,503,289.92
 - v. Other - \$195,024.67
- b. Planned capital costs related to fare collection in the next 4 years, if any are planned (including those within expected transit vehicle or other procurements). – Work on MST’s Open-loop Contactless Fare Payment System will likely be ongoing over the next four years to ensure the best possible service for riders. MST anticipates installing fare payment validators on its ADA mobility fleet over the next four years.
- vi. A statement of existing service plan and planned service changes through the end of 2023-24, and schedule data in General Transit Feed Specification (GTFS) format. –

Below is a link to MST’s developer resources webpage, which has the most up to date GTFS data: <https://mst.org/about-mst/developer-resources/>. MST implemented a major service change in December 2022. No additional changes of significance are expected through the end of 2023-24.

- vii. Expenditures on security and safety measures.
 - 1. This data should be submitted by those agencies that have current or changed levels of expenditure that are specific to security (including cybersecurity) and safety measures, if applicable to the agency or operators covered by the report.

In 2023, MST devoted roughly \$220,000, or 13.75%, of its IT budget to cybersecurity. This is expected to increase to 17.5% in 2024 to accommodate a 3rd party audit of the system to assess system vulnerabilities and develop a long-term strategy for MST’s cybersecurity. MST has \$901,350 budgeted for physical security in FY 24. This includes salaries for safety staff, security services, alarm systems, and armored car services.

- viii. Opportunities for service restructuring, eliminating service redundancies, and improving coordination amongst transit operators, including, but not limited to, consolidation of agencies or reevaluation of network management and governance structure.

MST recently completed and implemented a systemwide redesign that focused on improving efficiency, equity, and building long-term ridership. Staff are currently observing and adjusting the new service to ensure it is operating as efficiently and effectively as possible. Since the systemwide service change in December 2022, MST has seen an average of a 25% increase in monthly ridership when compared to the same period in 2022.

TIRCP PROJECT FACT SHEET – NOT TO EXCEED 2 PAGES

CITY OF KING TRAIN PLATFORM PROJECT

CITY OF KING

PHASE	START DATE	END DATE
Engineering	2020	2024
Construction	2024	2026

ANTICIPATED DATE OF CONSTRUCTION, IF APPLICABLE

2026

SUMMARY OF PROJECT SCOPE

The Project consists of building an Accelerated Rail Platform and consolidating the existing transit activities at First Street and Pearl Street. The Project includes opening Broadway Street across the railroad tracks and closing Pearl Street. The City is collaborating with the developer of the DTA-SP in extending Broadway Street across the railroad tracks with direct access to the historic downtown. As mentioned above, the DTA-SP is a mixed-use, transit-oriented development designed as a walkable community. The Project includes a twelve-hundred foot (1200') by sixteen foot (16') wide side platform to Amtrak's standards. The ultimate construction of the Multimodal Transit Station will include train a LEED building with bathrooms and carpooling areas (not included in this funding request).

TOTAL PROJECT COSTS (USD\$)

Construction Cost \$37,850,000

TOTAL PROJECT DEVELOPMENT COSTS (USD\$), IF APPLICABLE

Not Applicable

AMOUNT OF FUNDING USED FOR PROJECT MANAGEMENT, INCLUDING RTPA PROJECT MANAGEMENT (USD\$)

FUNDING SOURCE	FUNDING TYPE	FUNDING AMOUNT (USD\$)
ITIP	State	\$7,500,000
Amtrak	State	\$5,000,000

CalSTA	State	\$6,375,000
SB 125	State	\$7,500,000

ADDITIONAL PROJECT DETAILS (REQ) – NOT TO EXCEED 2 PAGES

EXPLANATION OF GREENHOUSE GAS REDUCING FEATURES OF THE PROJECT

The Project will serve to reduce GHG by 61,881 metric tons over the life of the Project. The GHG reductions attributable to each type of vehicle for the Project are summarized in the below table.

Table: Greenhouse Gas Emissions Reduction by Phase

Greenhouse Gas Emissions Reduction	Annual Average	Over Project Life (2022-2080)
Entire Project	1,066.91	61.881

EXPLANATION OF EXPECTED RIDERSHIP BENEFITS, INCLUDING INTEGRATION WITH REGIONAL MODES & PROVIDERS

The Project is expected to yield an average of 29000 passengers per year. This data was obtained from the Coast Rail study and a conservative assumption of the number of troops that will be using the train. With the increase in the population, an increase in ridership is expected. King City is in the Central Coast Travel Market and is expected to experience 29.7% increase in interregional travel to the San Francisco Bay Area and 27% increase in interregional travel with the Los Angeles Basin by 2040. Once the MTC is built, we expect an increase in ridership from the Fort Hunter Liggett (FHL) base as they develop their means and methods of transporting troops to their base. Troops from across the country currently fly into San Jose CA or San Francisco CA. The mode of transportation for the final 120 miles to the base is via private rental vehicles or military owned vehicles. It would be logical for troops to transfer from air travel to train travel from the San Francisco Bay Area to King City and then have a more logical transfer from King City to Fort Hunter Liggett (FHL).

The Project would be a new intercity rail route to supplement the Coast Starlight, and fill a gap in rail services between the cities of San Francisco, San Jose, Salinas, San Luis Obispo, Santa Barbara, Ventura, and Los Angeles. This service will increase ridership, reduce greenhouse gas emissions, provide integration between shuttle services to FHL and the Pinnacles National Monument and improve local, regional and statewide bus networks. The Project improves services to local and regional low-income communities and disadvantaged communities along the rail line. (See Figure 1.3.) The Project achieves coordination across multiple transit providers and invests in transit projects in an area of the state which has seen fewer transit capital investments from state sources.

IF APPLICABLE, EXPLANATION OF THE BENEFITS TO DISADVANTAGED & LOW-INCOME COMMUNITIES AND/OR HOUSEHOLDS (PER SB 535 AND AB 1550)

Small communities traditionally have not had the opportunity to participate in increasing regional transit access. The State's commitment to reduce GHG by expanding access to transit provides small rural communities like King City the ability to be part of the solution and implement long-range sustainable planning. King City is considered a low-income community. Agriculture is the largest industry providing employment with unemployment at 11.6 percent. Close to ninety percent (90%) of the residents identify as Hispanic. The median household income is well below the rest of Monterey County and the State. Approximately twenty-five percent (25%) of people in King City live in the poverty level. Household overcrowding remains a significant issue in King City. In 2013, approximately twenty-one percent (21%) of owner-occupied and forty-four percent (44%) of renter-occupied were overcrowded. Severe overcrowding is approximately seventeen percent (17%).